Assessment comments

Example 3: SLP2

Subject: Economics

Component: SL paper 2

Question 2 Part	Marks awarded	Marks available	Comments
(a)(i)	2	2	This definition clearly meets the requirements of the markscheme.
(a)(ii)	1	2	Two vague dimensions may be recognized with one mark, as indicated in the markscheme.
(b)(i)	3	3	The workings are correct (all the components of the current account have been summed up), as is the final value.
(b)(ii)	2	2	The working is correct, as is the final value (given to two decimal points).
(c)	4	4	Two marks are awarded for the diagram and two marks for the explanation. The diagram is correct and fully labelled. The response explains that the leone is needed to pay for Sierra Leone's exports. This is sufficient as support for the fall in demand for the leone.
(d)	4	4	Two marks are awarded for the diagram and two marks for the explanation. The diagram is correct and fully labelled. Note that the response should not be penalized for the equilibrium real output levels not being projected along the horizontal axis in the diagram, since the question concerns inflation and thus that information is not necessary. A link is established between fuel as a factor of production (needed for energy production) and firms' costs of production.
(e)	3	4	One mark is awarded for the diagram and two marks for the explanation. The elements are not presented adequately. "Higher" income and "more" productivity do not form a self-perpetuating cycle. The response clearly establishes that education equips workers with skills, allowing them to gain more income and thus break the poverty cycle.
(f)	4	4	Two marks are awarded for the diagram and two marks for the explanation. The diagram is fully labelled and shows the increase in supply together with the changes in market outcome (higher quantity and lower price). The response explains that adopting new farming practices would lower costs of production (a non-price determinant of supply), resulting in a higher quantity and a lower price for rice. This is a valid explanation as modern equipment may lead to higher yield and thus help spread fixed costs over a larger output, resulting in a lower unit cost.

Question 2 Part	Marks awarded	Marks available	Comments
(g)	14	15	The level descriptors are as noted below. Demands of the question (10-to-12 markband)/(13-to-15 markband): In all the arguments, the response clearly establishes how intervention may result in economic growth and/or economic development. • Theory (13-to-15 markband): All the arguments are fully explained using economic theory. For instance, the issue of diversification and the impact such policy may have on economic development are clearly established. • Terms (13-to-15 markband): The response demonstrates good use of economic terms throughout, especially the unit 4 terms. • Evaluation (10-to-12 markband): There is clear evidence of evaluation, but the synthesis could be more effective. • Use of text (13-to-15 markband): Information from the texts was used throughout the response to help support the arguments. Using the best-fit method, this response is awarded a mark in the middle of the 13-to-15 markband as it meets almost all the descriptors in that markband.
Total	**37**	**40**	